Proposal to establishing a regional rogaine branch of the NZRA

Region: **Marlborough**
Year: **2015**
Who: **Mondo Kopua**

At the NZRA 2014 AGM the following motion was passed.

"That the NZRA facilitates the forming of regional entities (branches) where there is a desire for this, plus a core rogaining national body (being the NZRA), and also investigates working more closely with the NZ Orienteering Federation."

There still remains a divide about where rogaining best sits. I suspect those people that wish to have rogaining under the umbrella of Orienteering NZ (ONZ) then this is what will happen while others who consider that the NZRA, whose primary focus is rogaining, will pursue forming a regional branch of NZRA. How and what role, services and structures NZRA will then provide overall and to also support any regional branch will be the next challenge to clarify.

I've already highlighted my desire to forming a regional branch and I know that I am fortunate to have access to a lot of areas that are suitable for rogaines and in most cases have only a few landowners. Due to the vast network in the farming community we have a positive relationship and portrayal in the region.

The Marlborough region has hosted 2x Championship events and many 3 – 6 hour events. A majority of participants at our rogaines do not participate at the local orienteering events. These people prefer rogaines due the strategy, landscapes, longer duration/endurance and the more social environment. Local support is also available to assist me with a regional branch and hosting of events. I'd like to think that I have a positive track record of hosting and organising events locally.

The local orienteering club used to hold regular rogaines when Alan Holdaway, Susan King and Barry Hope were active in the club. When they became less involved I and a few friends took over the mantle of organising rogaines. After being actively involved for 3 – 4 years I ran out of energy and having a young family at the time also influenced the time I could commit to organising. With the boys being older, more mobile and able to accompany me on 'reccys' I am in a position to become more engaged with organising and planning events.

Regional reps and/or branches can act as a contact point for local enquires as well as being responsible for hosting, nurturing and fostering rogaines in their regions. It also allows some autonomy and at the same time can lessen the dependence and reliance of the 'core' group of the NZRA. A regional branch may attract more engagement from the local community and volunteers. Often local people are more willing to be actively involved at a local level rather than at a national level.

I foresee that more collaboration with 'commercial event organisers', community groups, individuals and fundraisers will be an area where a regional branch can offer advice and assistance as well as facilitating an event. I've had two schools and a local equestrian club approach me about hosting an event as a fundraiser or another type of event for their members.

My view is that NZRA be the parent body and that regional branches are affiliated to the parent. We pay an annual subscription or a percentage of fees for events or participants. Hopefully this will cover annual costs of maintaining the NZRA website, FB page, insurance etc. Having NZRA as the parent body attracts better opportunities for funding applications that regional branches may make to local funding charities, discounted 'regional group' purchases, insurance cover with a larger insurance company.

Regions will have their own bank accounts, committees etc. I believe this will vastly reduce the administration required at NZRA level. It will be up to the regions to communicate and publicise their events and to feed this to the NZRA calendar. My plan would be to set up a web and Facebook page. One of my sponsors for the local Cyclocross series I organise has an online entry application that he is willing to copy and set up for me.

Attached is a draft budget for the establishment of a regional branch. I propose that the NZRA would purchase the items and meet some set up costs. Any assets/capital items would remain the property of the NZRA. The regional branch would be responsible for all running and operational costs. I would look to 'hire' flags/kites from either the local orienteering club or NZRA and hire NavLight from NZRA. Alternatively we could have a ‘spare’ NavLight set and have this to use and ‘hire’ out to other event organisers from other sporting codes.

Events:
As a minimum I would host a 6 (incl 3Hr) hour event annually. 12 hour (incl a 6Hr and 3Hr) event every 2 – 3 years and 24 hour every 4 – 5 years. I will assist other interested parties to host a rogaine.